MIL-P-43413D
7 May 1984
SUPERSEDING
MIL-P-43413C
15 May 1978

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

POLES, TENT, LIGHT METAL, SPECIAL

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This document covers special light metal tent poles.

1.2 Classification. Poles shall be of the following types and classes as specified (see 6.2):

Type I - Ridge

Type II - Upright

Class A - General Purpose Medium
Class B - General Purpose Large

Type III - Door

Type IV - Side Wall

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents. Unless otherwise specified, the following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research and Development Center, Natick, MA 01760 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 8340

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SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

QQ-A-200/8	-	Aluminum Alloy Bar, Rod, Shapes, Tube and Wire, Extruded, 6061
QQ-A-225/8	-	Aluminum Alloy Bar, Rod, Wire, and Special Shapes: Rolled, Drawn, or Cold Finished, 6061
QQ-A-250/11	-	Aluminum Alloy 6061, Plate and Sheet
QQ-A-596	-	Aluminum Alloy Permanent and Semipermanent Mold Castings
QQ-A-601	-	Aluminum Alloy Sand Castings
QQ-S-700	-	Steel Sheet and Strip, Medium and High Carbon
QQ-W-461	-	Wire, Steel, Carbon (Round, Bare, and Coated)
TT-E-529	-	Enamel, Alkyd, Semi-Gloss
TT-P-1757	-	Primer Coating, Zinc Chromate, Low-Moisture-Sensitivity
PPP-B-601	-	Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood
PPP-B-621	-	Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner
PPP-B-640	-	Boxes, Fiberboard, Corrugated, Triple-Wall
PPP-C-843	-	Cushioning Material, Cellulosic
PPP-P-291	-	Paperboard, Wrapping and Cushioning
PPP-T-76	-	Tape, Packaging, Paper, (For Carton Sealing)

MILITARY

MIL-C-43256	-	Cord, Polyester, Solid Braid

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	-	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129	-	Marking for Shipment and Storage

DRAWINGS

U.S. ARMY NATICK RESEARCH AND DEVELOPMENT CENTER

5-4-1001	-	Pole, Tent, Light Metal, Special for General Purpose Tents; Ridge Pole Assembly
5-4-1002	-	Pole, Tent, Light Metal, Special for General Purpose Tents; Door Pole
5-4-1003	-	Pole, Tent, Light Metal, Special for General Purpose Tents; Side Wall Pole
5-4-1004	-	Pole, Tent, Light Metal, Special for General Purpose Tents; Upright Pole (Special for GPM)

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5-4-1005 - Pole, Tent, Light Metal, Special for General Purpose Tents: Upright Pole (Special for GPL)

(Copies of documents required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. Unless otherwise specified, the following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

A 108 - Steel Bars, Carbon, Cold Finished, Standard Quality
B 449 - Chromatic Treatment on Aluminum
B 633 - Electrodeposited Coatings of Zinc on Iron and Steel
D 3951 - Commercial Packaging of Supplies and Equipment
E 18 - Rockwell Hardness and Rockwell Superficial Hardness of Metallic Materials

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

(Technical society and technical association documents are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document shall take precedence.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified (see 6.2), a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.3, 6.2, and 6.3).

3.2 Materials (see 6.4). The materials used shall conform to the applicable referenced documents and requirements specified herein. Where materials are not definitely specified, they shall be of the quality and type normally used by the manufacturer provided the completed item complies with all provisions of this document.

3.2.1 Steel.

3.2.1.1 Strip, medium carbon. Medium carbon strip steel shall conform to cold rolled annealed last, chemical composition No. 1045-1050 of QQ-S-700.

3.2.1.2 Wire. Steel wire shall conform to steel numbers 1006-1010, any temper, and finish 1 of QQ-W-461.

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3.2.1.3 Bar. Bar steel shall conform to grade designation 1020 and round form of ASTM A 108.

3.2.2 Aluminum alloy.

3.2.2.1 Rod and tube. Aluminum alloy rod and tube shall conform to composition 6061 and temper T6 of QQ-A-200/8 or QQ-A-225/8, as applicable.

3.2.2.2 Sheet. Aluminum alloy sheet shall conform to composition 6061 and temper T6 of QQ-A-250/11.

3.2.2.3 Castings.

3.2.2.3.1 Permanent and semi-permanent mold. Aluminum alloy permanent and semipermanent mold castings shall conform to alloy number 356, temper T6 of QQ-A-596.

3.2.2.3.2 Sand. Aluminum alloy sand castings shall conform to alloy number 356.0, temper T6 of QQ-A-601.

3.2.3 Cord. Cord shall be a minimum of 1/8 inch diameter conforming to MIL-C-43256.

3.2.4 Primer. Primer shall conform to composition G or L, as applicable, color Y of TT-P-1757.

3.2.5 Enamel. Enamel shall conform to class A or B, composition G or L, as applicable, olive drab color No. 24087 of TT-E-529.

3.2.6 Epoxy coating. As an alternate to the primer and enamel specified above, the tent poles may be coated with standard Corvell ECA-1555-FC3 epoxy coating. The color shall be Olive Drab No. 24087.

3.2.7 Enamel, acrylic. As an alternate to the coating requirements specified in 3.2.5 and 3.2.6, Duracon Super 600 acrylic enamel may be used to coat the tent pole.

3.3 Construction. Construction of the poles shall conform to Drawings 5-4-1001 through 5-4-1005 and as specified herein. An aluminum alloy casting for the lug may be used at the option of the contractor providing as follows:

a. Castings design and dimensions are submitted and approved by the contracting officer or his authorized representative prior to fabrication of the first article (when one is required) or the initial production unit.

b. Casting conforms to 3.2.2.3.1 or 3.2.2.3.2.

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3.4 Detail of components.

3.4.1 Latch. Latch shall be in accordance with Drawing 5-4-1001 and as specified herein. Latch shall be riveted to the pipe and spring shall be held tightly against the pole.

3.4.1.1 Spring. Spring shall be fabricated of material specified in 3.2.1.1. Following fabrication and welding of the catch to the spring, the spring shall be spring tempered and hardened to Rockwell C40-C45. When tested as specified in 4.4.1.1, the Rockwell hardness shall be within the limits of a minimum of C40 and a maximum of C45.

3.4.1.2 "D" ring. "D" ring shall be fabricated of material specified in 3.2.1.2 and in accordance with Drawing 5-4-1001.

3.4.1.3 Catch. Catch shall be fabricated of material specified in 3.2.1.3.

3.4.2 Spindle. Spindle shall be fabricated of material in 3.2.1.3 and as shown on applicable drawing.

3.4.3 Thong. Thong shall be fabricated of material specified in 3.2.3. The cord shall be looped through the "D" ring as shown on Drawing 5-4-1001. The end of each cord shall be knotted and the free end shall be seared.

3.5 Welding. Surfaces to be welded shall be clean, i.e., free from rust, scale, paint, grease, and other foreign matter. Acid used for cleaning shall be completely neutralized and removed. The deposited weld metal shall be thoroughly fused with the base metal along all surfaces and edges of the union. Plug welds shall completely fill the holes and their surfaces shall be flush with the outside surface of the pipe. Welds shall be sound, smooth, and free from cracks, scale, oxidation products, spatters, scabs, blisters, and pock marks.

3.6 Finish.

3.6.1 Plating zinc. After fabrication and welding, the steel latch assembly and spindle shall be given a zinc plating conforming to type IV, SC3 of ASTM B 633. Following the plating, the spring of the latch assembly shall be relieved of hydrogen embrittlement in accordance with ASTM B 633.

3.6.2 Chemical treatment. After welding and fabrication, but prior to assembly of the steel spring pins, latch assembly, spindle, thong, and binding strap assembly, all aluminum exterior surfaces shall be prepared for painting in accordance with class 2 requirements of ASTM B 449. Following the chemical treatment, the interior surfaces of the poles shall be thoroughly rinsed with hot water then dried to remove all of the chemical conversion solution. At the option of the contractor, plugs may be used to prevent the solution from entering the interior of the poles in lieu of the rinsing process.

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3.6.3 Priming. When using the enamel specified in 3.2.5, the pole shall be primed. After complete assembly except for thong and binding strap, exterior metal surfaces shall be coated with primer specified in 3.2.4. Mating surfaces of the latch assembly with the pipe shall be protected from receiving an excess of primer sufficient to prevent engagement or disengagement. Priming is not required when the epoxy coating or acrylic enamel specified in 3.2.6 and 3.2.7 is used.

3.6.4 Enameling. After drying, primed surfaces shall be coated with enamel specified in 3.2.5. The coating shall level out to an adherent, continuous, uniform film and shall be free from area of corrosion, scratch, dig, and abrasion exposing primer or bare metal. Mating surfaces of the latch assembly with the pipe shall be protected from receiving an excess of enamel sufficient to prevent engagement or disengagement.

3.6.5 Epoxy coating or acrylic enamel. When the coating specified in 3.2.6 or 3.2.7 is used as an alternate, it shall be applied in accordance with the manufacturer's instructions. The coating shall level out to an adherent, continuous, uniform film and shall be free from area of corrosion, scratch, dig, and abrasion exposing bare metal. Mating surfaces of the latch assembly with the pipe shall be protected from receiving an excess of epoxy coating or enamel sufficient to prevent engagement or disengagement.

3.7 Marking for identification. All poles shall be legibly marked with the letters "U.S." and the manufacturer's name or trade name, or trademark of such known characters as to be identifiable with the manufacturer. The letters shall be a minimum of 1/8 inch high.

3.8 Workmanship. Poles shall be free from split, puncture, burr, rough or sharp edge, malformation, deformation, or fracture. The latch assembly shall be capable of mating with the tubing. The sections of poles shall be capable of assembly and disassembly without the use of tools, e.g., pin will retain the lug. Pins, plugs, spindle, and lug shall be tightly assembled, i.e., not loose. The finished poles shall be clean and free from oil, grease, or dirt. Rivets shall be securely peened. Peened rivets shall be free of rough surface or sharp edge. Binding strap shall be free of any cut, tear, abrasion, or hole except as shown on Drawing 5-4-1004.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the document where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

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4.2 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.3).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4).

4.3 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.2), it shall be examined for the defects specified in 4.4.3 and 4.4.4. The presence of any defect shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.4 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.4.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this document or applicable purchase document.

4.4.1.1 Spring hardness testing. The springs shall be tested for Rockwell hardness in accordance with ASTM E 18 for conformance to the requirement in 3.4.1.1. Each sample unit shall be subjected to three individual scale reading determinations. Any sample unit having one or more individual scale readings below Rockwell C 40 or having the average of the three scale readings not within the limits of Rockwell C40 - C45 shall be classified as a defective. The lot size shall be expressed in units of springs. The sample unit shall be one spring. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 6.5.

4.4.2 In-process inspection.

4.4.2.1 In-process examination. Examination shall be made during the manufacturing process for the requirements specified in table I. Whenever a nonconformance is noted, correction shall be made to affected items and process.

TABLE I. In-process examination

Requirement or operation	Requirement or drawing reference
End of pins to be finished smooth to outside diameter of tubing	Drawings 5-4-1002 through 5-4-1005
Diameter of pins, hole in top plug, and spindle not as specified.	Drawings 5-4-1002 through 5-4-1005
Diameter of plugs to be a tight fit in tubing	Drawings 5-4-1002 through 5-4-1005

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TABLE I. In-process examination (cont'd)

Requirement or operation	Drawing or drawing reference
Welds and welding	3.5
Zinc plating	3.6.1
Chemical treatment	3.6.2
Application of primer	3.6.3
Mating surfaces of the latch assembly with the pipe are protected from receiving an excess of primer and enamel sufficient to prevent engagement or disengagement	3.6.3, 3.6.4 and 3.6.5

4.4.3 End item visual examination. The end item shall be examined for the defects listed in table II. The lot size shall consist of all completely fabricated poles of one type, and class, as applicable, submitted for inspection at one time. The sample unit shall be one pole. The inspection level shall be II and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 6.5 for major defects and 15.0 for total (major and minor combined) defects.

TABLE II. End item visual defects

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Finish	Not finished	X	
	Finish is not adherent, e.g., is blistered, peeled, or flaky		X
	Not a close match to specified color or the color is not uniform		X
	Coating is not continuous or not uniform, i.e., not coated or area of no film		X
	Area of corrosion		X
	Scratch, dig, or abrasion exposing primer or bare metal		X
Construction and workmanship	Any component missing	X	
	Any component not fabricated of the specified materials	X	
	Not fabricated as specified	X	

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TABLE II. End item visual defects (cont'd)

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Construction and workmanship (cont'd)	Split, puncture, burr, rough or sharp edge, malformation, deformation, or fracture	X	
	Not clean. i.e., evidence of oil, grease, or dirt	X	
	End of cord not knotted or free end not seared	X	
	Cut, tear, abrasion, or hole in binding strap (except as shown on Drawing 5-4-1004)		X
	Latch assembly not capable of mating with the tubing	X	
	Section of pole not capable of being assembled or disassembled, e.g., pin will not retain the lug	X	
Rivets and riveting	Rivet missing	X	
	Not specified type, size, or material		X
	Rivet is not peened, i.e., can be removed by hand	X	
	Rivet is not sufficiently peened, i.e., it cannot be removed by hand but the spring is not held tightly against the pole		X
	Peening of rivet results in rough surface or sharp edge.		X
Welds and welding	D-ring not welded	X	
	Any weld that is not specified type		X
	Evidence of rust		X
	Weld is not continuous or not welded "all around" where required		X
	Not thoroughly fused	X	
	Metal damaged or burnt by welding	X	
	Not sound and smooth, not free from crack, scale, spatter, scab, blister, or hole		X
	Plug weld does not completely fill the hole		X
	Surface of plug weld is not flush with the outside diameter of the tube		X

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TABLE II. End item visual defects (cont'd)

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Classification Minor
Marking, identification	Missing, incomplete, illegible, or incorrect		X

4.4.4 End item dimensional examination. The end item shall be examined for conformance to the dimensions specified on the drawings. Any dimension not within the specified tolerance shall be classified as a defect. The lot size shall be expressed in units of poles. The sample unit shall be one pole. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 6.5.

4.4.5 Packaging inspection. An examination shall be made to determine that packing and markings are in compliance with section 5 requirements. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table III. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully packaged with the exception that it need not be closed. Examination of closure defects listed below shall be made on shipping containers fully packaged. The lot size shall be the number of containers in the inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 6.5.

TABLE III. Packaging defects

Examine	Defect
Markings	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application
Materials	Any component missing, damaged, or not as specified
Workmanship	Poles not disassembled, as applicable Spindle, lug, or base of the type II pole not completely covered with cushioning material Cushioning material not secured with tape Contents not immobilized
Contents	Number of components per container is more or less than required

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4.4.6 Palletization examination. An examination shall be made to determine that the palletization complies with the section 5 requirements. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one palletized unit load fully packaged. The lot size shall be the number of palletized unit loads in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 6.5.

Examine	Defect
Finished dimensions	Length, width, or height exceeds specified maximum requirements.
Palletization	Pallet pattern not as specified. Interlocking of loads not as specified. Load not bonded with required straps as specified.
Weight	Exceeds maximum load limits.
Marking	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A or Commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. The types I and II poles shall be disassembled into sections prior to packing. Spindles, lugs, and bases of the type II poles shall be completely covered with cushioning material conforming to type I, style 1 of PPP-P-291 or type II, class B of PPP-C-843. The cushioning shall be secured with pressure sensitive tape conforming to PPP-T-76.

5.1.2 Commercial. The poles shall be preserved in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or Commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A packing. The tent poles shall be packed in the quantities as specified in table IV in a snug-fitting shipping container conforming to class 2, style 2 or 4, type 3 load of PPP-B-621 or overseas type, style A, B, or I, grade B, type 3 load of PPP-B-601. Each section of the type II pole shall be alternated within the shipping container and shall be immobilized in such a manner as to prevent damage of contents including end thrust during handling and transit. Each shipping container shall be closed and reinforced in accordance with the appendix of the applicable container specification.

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TABLE IV. Packing of poles

Item	Quantity of poles per shipping container
Type I ridge	2
Type II upright:	
Class A	4
Class B	4
Type III door	20
Type IV side wall	20

5.2.2 Level B packing. The tent poles shall be packed in the quantities as specified in table IV in a snug-fitting shipping container conforming to class 1, style B, with No. 2 end of PPP-B-640, or class 1, style 2 or 4, type 3 load of PPPB-621 or domestic type, style A or B, grade B of PPP-B-601. Each section of the type II pole shall be alternated within the shipping container and shall be immobilized in such a manner as to prevent damage of contents including end thrust during handling and transit. Each shipping container shall be closed and reinforced in accordance with the requirements of the applicable container specification.

5.2.3 Commercial packing. Poles preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

5.3 Palletization. When specified (see 6.2), tent poles, packed as specified in 5.2, shall be palletized in accordance with load type I of MIL-STD-147 . Each prepared load shall be bonded with primary and secondary straps in accordance with the bonding means K and L. Pallet patterns shall be in accordance with the appendix of MIL-STD-147. Interlocking of loads shall be effected by reversing the pattern of each course. If the container is of a size which does not conform to any of the patterns specified in MIL-STD-147, the pallet pattern used shall first be approved by the contracting officer.

5.4 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 or ASTM D 3951, as applicable.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Type I, type II - class A, type III, and type IV poles are intended to be used with the general purpose medium tent. Type II-class B, type III, and type IV poles are intended to be used with the general purpose large tent.

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6.1.1 Binding strap. The binding strap of the type II class A pole is intended to facilitate the packaging of poles in the type II case of MIL-C-43412 for transport. When two upright poles are disassembled and placed in the cover, the two top sections are strapped together so that their open ends are approximately 6 feet 4 inches apart.

6.2 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this document.
b. Type and class, as applicable, required (see 1.2).
c. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.3, and 6.3).
d. Selection of applicable level of packing (see 5.2).
e. When palletization is required (see 5.3).

6.3 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of DAR 7-104.55. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The first article should consist of one unit of each type and class, of pole required. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all acquisition documents regarding arrangements for inspection and approval of the first article.

6.4 Recycled material. It is encouraged that recycled material be used when practical as long as it meet the requirements of the specification (see 3.2).

6.5 Changes from previous issue. Asterisks are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

6.6 International standardization agreements. Certain provisions of this document are the subject of international standardization agreement as cited in NATO, STANAG NO. 2882, relative to camouflage requirements for tents, shelters and subsidiary components. When amendment, revision, or cancellation of this document is proposed which will affect or violate the international agreement concerned, the preparing activity will take appropriate reconciliation action through international standardization channels including departmental standardization offices, if required.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - NU
Air Force - 99

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8340-0451

Review activities:

Army - MD
Air Force - 82
DLA - CT

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NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document*(s)* or to amend contractual requirements.

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-P-43413D	Poles, Tent, Light Metal, Special

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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